

PAPER BOATS

Let us do these activities before we read.

I Read the questions given below. Share your answers with your classmates and the teacher.

1. What comes to mind when you think about ‘paper boats’?
2. What do you think someone might hope for when they send a paper boat down a stream?
3. Read the title of the poem ‘Paper Boats’ and predict what the poem might be about.

II Read the given paragraph and match the highlighted words with their meanings given in the box below.

loading speedily flowing swelling putting bouncing

I love to play beside a 1. **running** stream at a short distance from my grandparent’s house. I love to see it 2. **skipping** along to join a river. On the river, I can see boats with 3. **bulging** sails moving swiftly. Some of them take the people from one shore to the other while in some of them people can be seen 4. **lading** things too. I can spend hours watching the busy river and dreaming about them, 5. **burying** my head in my pillow at night.





Let us read

Day by day I float my paper boats one by one down the running stream.

In big black letters I write my name on them and the name of the village where I live.

I hope that someone in some strange land will find them and know who I am.

I load my little boats with shiuli flower from our garden, and hope that these blooms of the dawn will be carried safely to land in the night.

I launch my paper boats and look up into the sky and see the little clouds setting the white bulging sails.

I know not what playmate of mine in the sky sends them down the air to race with my boats!

When night comes I bury my face in my arms and dream that my paper boats float on and on under the midnight stars.

The fairies of sleep are sailing in them, and the lading is their baskets full of dreams.

RABINDRANATH TAGORE



Let us discuss

I Choose the correct words from the brackets to complete the summary of the poem given below.

The poet sends paper boats down a 1. _____ (stream/river) each day, writing his name and the name of his 2. _____ (school/ village) on them. He hopes that someone in a 3. _____ (strange/familiar) land will find them and know who he is. The poet fills his boats with 4. _____ (rose/shiuli) flowers from his garden, hoping they will be safely carried to another land at 5. _____ (night/morning). As he launches his boats, he imagines that the 6. _____ (clouds/birds) in the sky are like friends, racing with his boats. At night, he dreams that his paper boats continue to 7. _____ (swim/float) under the midnight stars, with the fairies of sleep sailing in them, their baskets full of 8. _____ (dreams/fruits).

II Choose the correct option for the following.

The theme of the poem is _____.

1. innocence 2. imagination 3. ignorance
4. playfulness 5. travel

- (i) 1, 2 and 3 (ii) 3, 4 and 5 (iii) 1, 4 and 5 (iv) 1, 2 and 4

III Identify whether the following statement is **true** or **false**.

The setting of the poem is a natural, outdoor environment.

IV Complete the following sentence by choosing the correct word given within the brackets.

The tone is _____ (sad and serious/gentle and wishful) and the mood is _____ (thoughtful/boring).

V Identify the examples of alliteration from the poem.

VI Fill in the blanks with suitable words from the poem.

- The repetition of words _____ and _____ emphasises the passage of time.
- The poet uses imagery like _____ and _____ to create a clear picture in the minds of the readers.



VII Match the descriptions in Column 1 with what they symbolise in Column 2.

Column 1	Column 2
1. the child's innocence, dreams, hopes, and messages sent out into the world	(i) midnight stars
2. purity, beauty, and the start of a new day	(ii) paper boats
3. the vast universe and the child's dreams continuing through the night	(iii) shiuli flowers



Let us think and reflect

I Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow.

1. *When night comes I bury my face in my arms and dream that my paper boats float on and on under the midnight stars. The fairies of sleep are sailing in them, and the lading is their baskets full of dreams.*

(i) Select the option that is most likely to be the speaker as per the extract.



A.



B.



C.

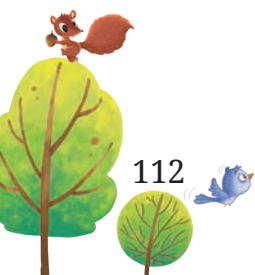


D.

(ii) What can be inferred about the speaker's feelings when night comes?

(iii) What kind of beings are the 'fairies of sleep' imagined as? Select the most appropriate option.

A. mischievous B. gentle C. fearsome D. playful





- (iv) Fill in the blank by selecting the correct option from those given in the brackets.

The phrase 'lading is their baskets full of dreams' suggests that the speaker imagines the fairies of sleep carefully _____
(carrying his dreams /collecting his wishes) in their baskets.

II Answer the following questions.

1. Why do you think the poet writes his personal details on the paper boats?
2. The poet talks about the imagination of a child. Support this view with examples from the poem.
3. How does the poet bring together imagination and reality to make the poem more interesting?



Let us learn

- I The poet has used phrases like 'blooms of the dawn' and 'fairies of sleep' in the poem. In the same way we can create phrases. Now, select words from Column 1 and Column 2 and combine them with 'of'. Write as many phrases as possible in Column 3. An example has been done for you.

Column 1		Column 2	Column 3
wings	of	the birds	wings of the wind
waves		the wind	
dreams		the evening	
songs		the children	
glimmers		the rain	
cries		the stars	
tears		the thunder	
roars		the ocean	
shadows		the clouds	



II The poet uses words like 'dawn', 'night' and 'midnight' to show different parts of the day. The box given below has some more words. Write the words in the appropriate columns.

twilight dawn dusk sunrise noon daybreak
nightfall sunset midnight sunup forenoon sundown
noontime night-time noontide midday

Morning	Afternoon	Evening	Night

III Match the words from the text given in Column 1 with their opposites in Column 2.

Column 1

1. strange
2. dawn
3. launch
4. bulging
5. float
6. lading

Column 2

- (i) halt
- (ii) emptying
- (iii) sink
- (iv) dusk
- (v) ordinary
- (vi) shrinking



Let us listen

You will listen to a conversation between a girl and her father about the art of paper folding called origami. As you listen, select the **true** statements from 1–7. (Transcript for the teacher on pg. 137)

1. Sai was trying to make an origami boat.
2. Sai's father used to do origami as a child.
3. Paper was very expensive so it was used only for special occasions.
4. People have been making paper cranes for thousands of years.
5. There is a belief that if you make a thousand paper cranes, your wish will come true.
6. The art of origami is about enjoying the process.
7. Sai's father suggests making a paper bookmark next time.



Let us speak

Create any craft item using eco-friendly materials. Make a presentation in front of your classmates and teacher about the craft item you have made.

Your presentation should include the following information:

- Introduction of the item
- Description of how you made it
- Reason why you like the craft
- Conclusion

Use the phrases given below to make your presentation.

- Today, I'm going to show you a... I made.
- This... is made of... (materials)
- It's... (describe colour, shape, size)
- It can be used to...
- First, I started by...
- Then, I used... (tool or material) to...
- The most difficult part was to...
- This... is special to me because...
- I hope you enjoyed seeing my craft and learning about it.
- Thank you for your attention.





Let us write

A diary entry is a personal document. It records an individual's account of a day of her or his life expressing the thoughts, feelings and opinions in the individual's mind.

The guidelines to compose a diary entry include:

- mentioning day, date and time of writing it
- beginning with a general sentence describing the day or feelings towards an event or experience
- giving details
- concluding with a final remark

Now, write a diary entry expressing your joy experiencing a rainy day. You may begin as given below:

Friday, 15 July 20XX

6:30 p.m.

Dear Diary,

It was quite humid today. On my journey back from school, I wished that it would rain. And it did! ...



Let us explore



I *Shiuli* flowers often find a mention in Rabindranath Tagore's poems. These flowers are found in many parts of our country.

Look at the pictures of *shiuli* flowers and recall what you call them in your language.

1. Find out names of some more trees or plants in your locality which have fragrant flowers. Write their names in your language and English language. Draw any two flowers and colour them.



II Solve the riddles given below. Share your answers with your classmates and the teacher.

1. I have water that you cannot drink,
People come to see how in me the Sun sinks.
I can be rough, I can be calm,
I hold within myself plenty of charm.
My depths tell a never-ending tale.
Who am I with dolphins and the whale?



2. I sit in stillness, but move with the wind,
My surface mirrors the world you are in.
The trees around me live happily,
In me, you can take a dip daily.
Home to ducks, frogs, fish, and all,
Can you guess what I am, after all?

3. I gently travel through valleys deep,
My soft murmur can make you sleep.
Little paper boats float on me in rain
The merry laughter of the kids I gain.
You may sit beside me without any fear,
Who am I who skips along, crystal clear?



4. I have a bed, but I do not sleep.
I have a bank, but no money I keep.
I carry stories, old and new,
High mountains to the oceans blue.
I journey far to meet the sea,
Can you guess, who I can be?

